

MOROCCO

Age - 35

Club - Al Hilal

Int. caps - 89

Yassine Bounou

Following his heroics in Morocco's run to a fourth-place finish at the 2022 World Cup, Yassine Bounou's move to Al Hilal was viewed by some as an early retirement of sorts.

The 6'3" goalkeeper, however, had other plans. In his first season in Saudi Arabia, he kept 15 clean sheets in 31 matches and was named the league's best goalkeeper as Al Hilal secured the title.

For the national team, he was most recently in action at the Africa Cup of Nations 2025, where he once again proved his worth in penalty situations, replicating his 2022 heroics — this time against Nigeria in the semifinal.

Despite losing the final 0-1 to Senegal, Morocco was later awarded the title under controversial circumstances, with Bounou winning the Golden Glove. His willingness to face any shot head-on helped him concede just two goals and record five clean sheets in seven games.

While Morocco was dubbed the dark horse of the last edition, the surge in its quality since then makes its success no longer surprising. With the team's outfield players supported by Bounou's commanding presence at the back, the side carries not just defensive assurance but a psychological edge even before the first kick of the ball.

